

Annie Li Zhang

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

- 2026 – **Florida State University**, Tallahassee, FL
present Assistant Professor of Science Communication, School of Communication
- 2025 – **University of Washington Center for an Informed Public**, Seattle, WA
2026 Postdoctoral Fellow, Information School

EDUCATION

- Ph.D.** **University of Michigan**, Ann Arbor, MI
2025 Communication and Media
- B.S.** **University of Texas**, Austin, TX
2020 Chemistry Honors | Minor: Science Communication

RESEARCH FOCI

Science, Health, and Environmental Communication; Public Engagement with Science; Social and Digital Media; Strategic Communication and Persuasion; Media Psychology; Media Effects

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

* indicates equal contribution

1. **Zhang, A. L.** (*in press*). Understanding How Exposure to Science Content on Social Media Shapes Normative Expectations of Scientists' Communication: A Social Media Affordances Perspective. *Public Understanding of Science*.
2. Moses, A., **Zhang, A. L.**, Todorovic, M., Ramakrishna, R., Facciani, M., Eagleman, D. M., Sever, R., Eyre, H. A., Bhamla, S., Moore, J. P., Chapman, S. B., Ramos, K. M., Hayden, E. C., Malenka, R. C., & Rein, B. (2026). Modern science outreach: A guide for scientists. *Cell*, 189(17), 5174–5181. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cell.2026.07.014>
3. Li, Y., **Zhang, A. L.**, & Lu, H. (2026). Stitching, dueting, and playing with science on TikTok: An AI-powered multimodal approach to understanding interactive science videos and audience engagement. *Computational Communication Research*, 8(4), 1–29. <https://doi.org/10.5117/CCR2026.4.2.LI>

4. Hart, P. S., Feldman, L., Choi, S., & **Zhang, A. L.** (2026). Unequal Risks, Unequal Responses: Differential Effects of Emphasizing Race vs. Class Disparities in News Stories about Climate Impacts. *Science Communication*. OnlineFirst. <https://doi.org/10.1177/10755470251397919>
5. **Zhang, A. L.** (2026). Performing ‘the scientist,’ credibly and authentically: Understanding how scientists manage their self-presentation on social media. *Information, Communication & Society*, 29(8), 2353–2373. <https://doi.org/10.1080/1369118X.2025.2565313>
6. **Zhang, A. L.**, & Lu, H (2025). When Scientists Share Struggles: How Scientists’ Self-Presentation Can Influence Public Perceptions, Support for Science, and Information Seeking Intentions. *Science Communication*, 48(2), 189-216. <https://doi.org/10.1177/10755470251322902>
7. **Zhang, A. L.**, & Lu, H. (2024). Behind the lab coat: How scientists’ self-disclosure on Twitter influences source perceptions, tweet engagement, and scientific attitudes through social presence. *New Media & Society*, 26(10), 5784–5801. <https://doi.org/10.1177/14614448221141681>
8. Hart, P. S., Feldman, L., Choi, S., **Zhang, A. L.**, & Hegland, A. (2023). The Influence of Flooding Imagery and Party Cues on Perceived Threat, Collective Efficacy, and Intentions for Political Action to Address Climate Change. *Science Communication*, 45(5), 627-664. <https://doi.org/10.1177/10755470231199972>
9. **Zhang, A. L.**, & Lu, H. (2023). Scientists as Influencers: The Role of Source Identity, Self-Disclosure, and Anti-Intellectualism in Science Communication on Social Media. *Social Media + Society*, 9(2), 1-16. <https://doi.org/10.1177/20563051231180623>
10. **Zhang, A. L.**, & Lu, H. (2022). No Laughing Matter: Exploring the Effects of Scientists’ Humor Use on Twitter and the Moderating Role of Superiority. *Science Communication*, 44(4), 418–445. <https://doi.org/10.1177/10755470221114352>
11. Hegland, A.*, **Zhang, A. L.***, Zichettella, B.* & Pasek, J. (2022). A Partisan Pandemic: How Covid-19 Was Primed for Polarization. *The Annals of the American Academy of Political and Social Science*, 700(1), 55-72. <https://doi.org/10.1177/00027162221083686>

RESEARCH GRANTS

External Grants

2024 – *National Science Foundation (NSF) Doctoral Dissertation Research Improvement Grant in Decision, Risk, and Management Science. “Impressions Matter: The Role of Scientists’ Self-Presentation in Effective Risk Communication on Social Media.” \$23,891 Total. (Award [#2343542](#); role: co-PI; PI: Lu, H.)*

Internal Grants

- 2025 *University of Michigan Department of Communication & Media* Dissertation Research Grant. “An Affordances Approach to Online Science Communication & Engagement on Social Media.” \$5,000 Total. (**role: PI**)
- 2023 *UM Rackham Graduate School* Pre-Candidate Research Grant. “Understanding Scientists’ Self-Presentation on Social Media.” \$1,500 Total. (**role: PI**)
- 2023 *UM Department of Communication & Media* Graduate Student Diversity Research Grant. “A Case Study of How the #Blackin__ Social Media Movement Created Space and Visibility for Black Scientists.” \$3,000 Total. (**role: co-PI; PI: Bridgewater, E.E.**)
- 2022 *UM Department of Communication & Media* Science & Environmental Communication Graduate Research Grant. “Examining Normative Expectations of Science Communication and its Role on Message Reception and Interpretation.” \$1,200 Total. (**role: co-PI; PI: Hegland, A.**)
- 2022 *UM Department of Communication & Media* Winthrop B. Chamberlain Graduate Student Research Grant. “How Race and Gender Cues on Twitter Influence Perceptions and Stereotypes of Scientists.” \$4,500 Total. (**role: PI; co-PI: Bridgewater, E.E.**)

AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS

- 2026 Mark Foote Distinguished Dissertation Award, *Department of Communication & Media, University of Michigan*
- 2025 Top Student Paper (1st Place), *Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication (AEJMC) Communicating Science, Health, Environment and Risk (ComSHER) Division*
- 2024 Top Faculty Paper (3rd Place), *AEJMC ComSHER Division*
- 2024 Oxford Media Policy Institute Summer Fellow, *Programme in Comparative Media Law and Policy, University of Oxford, UK*
- 2024 – 2025 Rackham Predoctoral Fellowship (full tuition and living stipend), *Rackham Graduate School, University of Michigan*
- 2024 Student and Young Professional Travel Award, *Society for Risk Analysis (SRA)*
- 2024 Digital IDEAS (Inclusion, Diversity, Equity, Access, and Success) Summer Institute Scholarship, *The DISCO Network and University of Michigan*

- 2022 William R. and Flora Hewlett Foundation Award, *Rackham Graduate School, University of Michigan*
- 2021 Inter-university Consortium for Political and Social Research (ICPSR) Summer Training Award, *University of Michigan*

PEER-REVIEWED CONFERENCE PAPERS & PRESENTATIONS

1. **Zhang, A. L., & Lu, H. (2026).** Understanding effects of narratives about scientific setbacks: affective and cognitive pathways to public support for science and scientists. Poster presented at the 109th AEJMC Annual Conference, New Orleans, Louisiana
2. Bunquin, J. B., & **Zhang, A. L. (2026).** “POV: You’re a Scientist on TikTok”: Engagement Strategies of Science Communicators on TikTok. Paper presented at the 2026 International Association for Media and Communication Research (IAMCR) Annual Meeting, Galway, Ireland.
3. **Zhang, A. L. (2025).** A Social Media Affordances Approach Towards Understanding How Science Observation Influences Normative Perceptions of Risk Communication and Trust in Scientists. Paper presented at the 2025 SRA Annual Meeting, Washington D.C.
4. **Zhang, A. L. (2025).** Performing “The Scientist:” Understanding How Scientists Manage Their Self-Presentation on Social Media. Paper presented at the 108th AEJMC Annual Conference, San Francisco, California
***First Place – Top Student Paper Award**
5. Hart, P. S., Feldman, L., Choi, S., **Zhang, A. L. (2025).** Racial Attitudes and the Unequal Impacts of Climate Change: How Emphasizing Class or Race in News Stories Influences Public Perceptions and Support for Climate Policies. Paper presented at the 108th AEJMC Annual Conference, San Francisco, California
6. Zichettella, B., **Zhang, A.L.,** Pasek, J. (2025). Automating the Oracle: Leveraging AI for Enhanced Analysis of Open-Ended Responses. Paper presented at the 2025 American Association for Public Opinion Research (AAPOR) Conference, St. Louis, Missouri
7. **Zhang, A. L., & Lu, H. (2024).** Communicating Norms about Transparent Science and Risk Communication Can Shape Public Support for Science and Scientists. Poster presented at the 2024 SRA Annual Meeting, Austin, Texas
8. **Zhang, A. L., & Lu, H. (2024).** Unveiling Imperfections: How Scientists’ Self-Presentation Can Influence Public Perceptions, Science Advocacy, and Information Seeking Intentions. Paper presented at the 107th AEJMC Annual Conference, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
***Third Place – Top Faculty Paper Award**
9. Zichettella, B., **Zhang, A.L.,** Hasell, A., Chinn, S. (2024). Examining the Relationship between Anti-Establishment Views, Emotion, and Covid-19 Mitigation Behaviors in the

U.S. Paper presented at the 74th International Communication Association (ICA) Annual Conference, Gold Coast, Australia

10. Hasell, A., **Zhang, A.L.**, Zichettella, B., Chinn, S. (2023). The Role of Emotion in Shaping Pandemic Responses Among Those with Anti-Intellectual and Populist Views in the U.S. Paper presented at the Pandemic Communication in Times of Populism Symposium, UK
11. **Zhang, A. L.**, Bridgewater, E.E., & Harrison, K. (2023). In Science We Trust: Race and Gender Cues Interact with Trust in Science to Influence Reactions to Scientists' Social Media Posts. Paper presented at the 73rd ICA Annual Conference, Toronto, Canada
12. Hart, P.S., Feldman, L., Choi, S., **Zhang, A.L.**, Hegland, A.P. (2023). The Influence of Flooding Imagery and Party Cues on Perceived Threat, Collective Efficacy, and Intentions for Political Action to Address Climate Change. Paper presented at the 73rd ICA Annual Conference, Toronto, Canada
13. **Zhang, A. L.**, & Lu, H. (2022). Behind the Lab Coat: How Scientists' Self-Disclosure on Twitter Influences Source Perceptions. Poster presented at the 105th AEJMC Annual Conference, Detroit, Michigan
14. **Zhang, A. L.**, & Lu, H. (2022). No Laughing Matter: Exploring the Effects of Scientists' Humor Use on Twitter and the Moderating Role of Superiority. Paper presented at the 72nd ICA Annual Conference, Paris, France
15. Pasek, J., Hegland, A., **Zhang, A. L.**, & Zichettella, B. (2022). A Partisan Pandemic: How Covid-19 Was Primed for Polarization. Paper presented at the 77th AAPOR Annual Conference, Chicago, Illinois
16. **Zhang, A. L.**, & Kahlor, L.A. (2020). Effective Framing of Climate Change Evidence to Influence Audience Perceptions. Poster presented at the 2020 SRA Annual Meeting (virtual due to COVID-19)

INVITED TALKS & PRESENTATIONS

Oct 2026	From Dissemination to Engagement: Perspectives on Science Communication. Invited Speaker. Behavioral Insights Research Center, <i>Institute for Public Relations</i> .
Oct 2026	From UFOs to UAPs: Science, Sensationalism, and Things That Go Blip in the Night. Invited Panelist. <i>Florida State University Libraries</i> , Tallahassee, FL
April 2026	Knowing your audience: Strategic audience analysis for public engagement. Invited training session. <i>Research Impact Advocates program</i> , University of Washington, Seattle, WA

Feb 2026 Trust, Truth, and Technology: Building Information Literacy in the Age of AI. Invited Panelist. *Institute for Health Metrics and Evaluation*, Seattle, WA

March 2025 Scientists' Self-Presentation on Social Media and Implications for Healthy Science-and-Society Relationships. *Center for an Informed Public*, Seattle,

TEACHING EXPERIENCES

Florida State University, School of Communication

Instructor – Undergraduate

Persuasion
Introduction to Science Communication
Social Media Campaigns

University of Michigan, Department of Communication and Media

Graduate Student Instructor

Public Speaking in the Digital Age, COMM290: *Winter 2023, Winter 2022*
Media Effects and Processes, COMM102: *Fall 2021, Fall 2022* (Lead GSI)

Additional Training & Experiences

2024 **Graduate Teacher Certificate**, Center for Research on Learning & Teaching

2021 – 2024 **Consultant**, Foundational Course Initiative for Equity-Based Teaching, Center for Research on Learning & Teaching

- Incorporated equity-focused pedagogical approaches that attend to systemic inequality and promote success of students
- Designed active learning activities to complement lecture materials during redevelopment of course syllabus (Media Effects & Processes)

SERVICE

Ad Hoc Reviewer

Journals

AI & Society; Computers in Human Behavior (2); Humanities and Social Sciences Communications (2); Information, Communication and Society (2); International Journal of Public Opinion Research; International Journal of Science Education; International Journal of Science Education, Part B; Journal of Environmental Psychology (3); Journal of Science Communication (2); Psychology, Health & Medicine; Science Communication (2); Scientific Report; Scientometrics; Social Media + Society

Conferences

ICA (Mass Communication Division; Environmental Communication Division); AEJMC (ComSHER Division)

University Service

Florida State University, School of Communication

2026 – 2027 Library Liaison

University of Washington, Center for an Informed Public (CIP)

2026 Postdoctoral Scholar Search Committee Member

2025 – 2026 CIP Weekly Seminar Organizer and Coordinator

University of Michigan, Department of Communication and Media

2024 Media Psychology Faculty Search Committee Student Representative

2024 Event Coordinator, Science and Environmental Communication Conference

2023 – 2024 Incoming Graduate Student Mentor, First Year Mentorship Program

2022 – 2023 Graduate Student Representative

ACADEMIC AFFILIATIONS

Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication (AEJMC), International Communication Association (ICA), Society for Risk Analysis (SRA)

RELEVANT PROFESSIONAL WORK

- 2019 **Science Communications Intern at Cell Press, Elsevier Inc. – Boston, MA**
- Authored press releases for high-impact journals including *Cell*, *Chem*, and *Neuron*, translating complex scientific findings into clear, compelling public communications.
 - Managed media outreach and served as primary press contact for one of the world's leading scientific publishers.
 - Owned promotional campaigns spotlighting major journal publications, conferences, and institutional research partnerships.
- 2016 – **Science Editor & Reporter for The Daily Texan – Austin, TX**
2019
- Led the Science & Technology section, building a 12-person editorial team and instituting rigorous reporting standards and ethics training.

- Oversaw all editorial operations, including story development, copy editing, and multimedia coordination, to ensure accuracy and impact in science journalism.
- Mentored student journalists in AP Style, interview techniques, and critical science communication practices.

2017 –
2018

Science Reporter for College of Natural Sciences – *Austin, TX*

- Bridged academic research and public audiences by producing feature articles, podcasts, and digital media on cutting-edge science.
- Conducted in-depth interviews with faculty and researchers to highlight discoveries in accessible, engaging formats.
- Enhanced the College’s public profile by curating social media content and shaping its science storytelling strategy.